



Dagpenger

PENGESTØTTE

Unemployment benefit in brief

Kopier lenke: <https://www.nav.no/dagpenger/en#in-brief>

Oppdatert 05/07/2023, 13:26

Unemployment benefit (dagpenger) is a financial support you may get if you are unemployed or temporarily laid off.

Unemployment benefit is for you who are

Unemployed or temporarily laid off (<https://www.nav.no/arbeidsledig-permittert>)

Looking for work (<https://www.nav.no/soker-jobb>)

Need help finding a job (<https://www.nav.no/komme-i-jobb>)

#who

Who qualifies?

Kopier lenke: <https://www.nav.no/dagpenger/en#who>

Oppdatert 07/07/2023, 11:42

If you are unemployed or have been temporarily laid off, you may get unemployment benefit from NAV if all of this applies to you:

- You have lost 50 percent or more of your total working hours.
- You have lost your income, or your income has been reduced.
- You have had an income of at least NOK 177 930 (1.5 G - [National Insurance basic amount \(G\)](https://www.nav.no/grunnbelopet)) in the last 12 months, or at least NOK 355 860 (3 G) in the last 36 months.
- You are under the age of 67.

^ What income qualifies you for unemployment benefit?

We use the following types of income to calculate if you qualify for unemployment benefit:

- Salary
- Parental benefit paid to you as an employee
- Pregnancy benefit paid to you as an employee
- Pregnancy-related sickness benefit paid to you as an employee

Self-employment income does not count as salary in this case.

To get unemployment benefit, you must:

- [apply for unemployment benefit #apply](#)
- [register as a job seeker](https://www.nav.no/arbeid/registrering) (<https://www.nav.no/arbeid/registrering>)
- be resident in Norway and [have Norwegian national insurance coverage](https://www.nav.no/en/home/rules-and-regulations/membership-of-the-national-insurance-scheme) (<https://www.nav.no/en/home/rules-and-regulations/membership-of-the-national-insurance-scheme>)
- submit an employment status form (meldekort) every 14 days
- be a genuine job seeker

Read more about [what you must do to get unemployment benefit #do](#).

^ Do you have multiple jobs?

The requirement is that your total working hours must be reduced by at least 50 percent. If you have multiple jobs, you must have lost at least 50 percent of your combined working hours to qualify for unemployment benefit.

Example

You have two jobs and work a total of 30 hours per week. You work 20 hours per week for one employer and 10 hours per week for the other. In this case, you must have lost at least 15 working hours in order to qualify for unemployment benefit.

^ Are you staying abroad?

There are some exceptions to the requirement of having to reside in Norway to get unemployment benefit. Read more about [unemployment benefit and EEA countries](https://www.nav.no/no/person/arbeid/dagpenger-ved-arbeidsloshet-og-permittering/dagpenger-under-arbeidsloshet-i-eos-land) (<https://www.nav.no/no/person/arbeid/dagpenger-ved-arbeidsloshet-og-permittering/dagpenger-under-arbeidsloshet-i-eos-land>).

^ Are you receiving other financial support?

Some types of financial support may be combined with unemployment benefit, but then your unemployment benefit may be reduced. In your application, you must specify if you are receiving other financial support, and NAV will calculate how much your unemployment benefit will be reduced.

Displaying information for

☐ I am unemployed

☐ I am temporarily laid off

☒ No filters are selected, all content is displayed.

If you are unemployed

The reason for your unemployment may affect your unemployment benefit. Check to see which rules apply to your situation.

^ Did you resign from your job?

If you resigned from your job, you may get unemployment benefit. You should apply one week before the last day you are entitled to salary from your employer. To avoid losing days with unemployment benefit, you must, apply at the latest, on the day you no longer are entitled to salary.

If you had **reasonable cause** to resign from your job, you will get unemployment benefit from the first day you are entitled to it.

If you did **not have reasonable cause** to resign from your job, you will not get unemployment benefit for the first 18 weeks.

Examples of reasonable cause include being unable to continue in your job due to health issues or having experienced bullying or harassment in the workplace. You must be able to provide documentation to prove this.

In any event, you must apply for unemployment benefit first. When you have applied, NAV will assess whether you had reasonable cause to resign from your job or not.

^ Were you terminated or dismissed from your job?

If you were terminated from your job, you may get unemployment benefit. You should apply one week before the last day you are entitled to salary from your employer. To avoid losing days with unemployment benefit, you must, apply at the latest, on the day you no longer are entitled to salary.

If you were **not personally responsible** for being terminated or dismissed, you will get unemployment benefit from the first day you qualify.

If you were **personally responsible** for being terminated or dismissed, you will not get unemployment benefit for the first 18 weeks.

In any event, you must apply for unemployment benefit first. When you have applied, NAV will assess whether you were personally responsible for being terminated or dismissed.

^ **Did your employer go bankrupt?**

If you lost your job because your employer went bankrupt, you may get an advance on wage guarantee funds in the form of unemployment benefit for a period of up to one month. Tick the box for this in your application for unemployment benefit.

Read more about [bankruptcy and the wage guarantee scheme](https://www.nav.no/no/person/arbeid/dagpengerved-arbeidsloshet-og-permittering/lonnsgarantiordningen) (<https://www.nav.no/no/person/arbeid/dagpengerved-arbeidsloshet-og-permittering/lonnsgarantiordningen>).

^ **Did you lose your self-employment income?**

When you are self-employed, you do not qualify for unemployment benefit. That is because self-employment income from sole proprietorships do not count as salary when NAV assesses if you qualify for unemployment benefit.

You may still qualify for unemployment benefit if you have had salary from another employer in the last 12 or 36 months.

^ **Did you lose your job in a limited company (aksjeselskap) you own?**

If you worked for your own limited company and received salary as an employee, you may qualify for unemployment benefit.

^ **Did you lose your freelance job?**

If you have had freelance income, you may get unemployment benefit.

^ **Were you recently discharged from the military?**

If you were recently discharged from the Norwegian military and are unemployed, you may get unemployment benefit regardless of your past income. You may receive unemployment benefit for a period of up to 26 weeks, regardless of your past income.

^ **Did you lose your job as a fisher?**

Fishers have a separate unemployment benefit scheme, managed by the Guarantee Fund for Fishers. Read more about how to [apply for unemployment benefit from the Guarantee Fund for Fishers](https://www.garantikassen.no/tjenester/dagpenger) (<https://www.garantikassen.no/tjenester/dagpenger>).

Self-employment income from fisheries, does not qualify you for unemployment benefit.

If you have been temporarily laid off

When you are temporarily laid off, you are entitled to get paid by your employer for the first 15 workdays of your temporary lay-off period. If you are partly temporarily laid off, the 15 paid workdays might go on for a longer period of time. After this paid period, you may qualify for unemployment benefit.

In order to qualify for unemployment benefit while being temporarily laid off, the reason for your temporary lay-off must be lack of work or other circumstances beyond your employer's control. This means the reason for your temporary lay-off may affect your right to unemployment benefit. NAV will assess if the reason for your temporary lay-off qualifies you for unemployment benefit.

^ Have you been temporarily laid off due to strike or labour dispute?

If you are temporarily laid off from your job due to strike or labour dispute,

- **you are not entitled to unemployment benefit** if your pay or employment conditions are affected by the strike or dispute.
- **you are entitled to unemployment benefit** if your pay or employment conditions are not affected by the strike or dispute.

^ Have you been temporarily laid off from the fisheries industry?

If you are temporarily laid off from the fisheries industry, you may get unemployment benefit if your working hours have been reduced by at least 40 percent. As an employee in the fisheries industry, you may get unemployment benefit from the first day of your temporary lay-off period, as you are not entitled to pay from your employer.

You are considered an employee in the fisheries industry, if you work in a fish processing enterprise, a fish oil enterprise or in the seafood industry.

^ Have you been temporarily laid off from your own limited company (aksjeselskap)?

If you are the only employee in your own limited company, you may temporarily lay yourself off by up to 80 percent, and still qualify for unemployment benefit.

If you temporarily lay yourself off by more than 80 percent, NAV will consider this as you not doing everything you can to secure more work and to avoid temporary layoffs.

^ Have you been temporarily laid off due to fire or other unforeseen events?

You may be entitled to unemployment benefit if you are temporarily laid off from your job due to unforeseen events, such as fire, accidents, flooding and landslides.

In the case of such events, the rule about employers having to pay their employees for the first 15 workdays does not apply. This means you may get unemployment benefit from the first day of your temporary lay-off period.

Are you on sick leave?

Read more about what to do, and what your rights are, [if you are both unemployed or temporarily laid off, and on sick leave](https://www.nav.no/sykmeldt-og-permittert) (<https://www.nav.no/sykmeldt-og-permittert>).

Are you getting an education, or would you like to get one?

You may get an education or receive training to increase your chances of finding a new job. If you want to combine getting an education or receive training with unemployment benefit, you need to apply for this.

Read more about [the rules for combining unemployment benefit with education, and how to apply](#).

#how-much

How much can you get?

Kopier lenke: <https://www.nav.no/dagpenger/en#how-much>

Oppdatert 06/07/2023, 12:49

We calculate how much unemployment benefit you can get, based on your income for the last 12 months, or the average for the last 36 months. We will apply the alternative that benefits you the most.

You may get up to 62.4 percent of your past income up to NOK 711 720 (6 G – [National Insurance basic amount](#) (<https://www.nav.no/grunnbelopet>)).

Calculator

Fill in your income to see if you qualify for unemployment benefit. The calculation is only an estimate.

Select income period

☒ Last 12 months

☐ Last 36 months

^ What income period should you choose?

When you apply for unemployment benefit, we choose the alternative that is best for you.

If you have had an income of at least 177 930 NOK (1,5 G) in the last 12 months, you can choose the last 12 months as your income period.

If you have had an income of less than 177 930 NOK in the last 12 months, but have had a total income of at least 355 860 NOK (3 G) in the last 36 months, you should choose the last 36 months as your income period.

i If you apply for unemployment benefit before 1st June, you need to have had an income of at least 195,240 NOK (1.5 G) in the last 12 months, or at least 390,480 NOK (3 G) collectively in the last 36 months.

What income have you had in the last 12 months?

From May 2025
to April 2026

^ What types of income determine how much you can get?

We use the following types of income to calculate your unemployment benefit amount:

- Salary
- Sickness benefit
- Care benefit
- Attendance allowance
- Training allowance
- Pregnancy benefit
- Parental benefit in connection with birth or adoption
- Unemployment benefit

These incomes are not considered as salary:

- Self-employment income
- Work assessment allowance (AAP)

Do you provide for children under the age of 18?

☐ Yes

☐ No

^ Why do we ask if you provide for children?

If you provide for children under the age of 18, you will get child supplement of 38 NOK per child, 5 days per week. This is a total of 190 NOK per week per child. If you provide for a child, you are entitled to child supplement even if the child does not live with you.

The child must live in Norway or another EEA country. If the child, over a period of 12 months, spends more than 90 days outside of Norway or another EEA country, you will no longer receive child supplement.

Calculate

^ **Do you provide for children under the age of 18?**

If you provide for children under the age of 18, you will get child supplement of NOK 35 per child, 5 days per week. This is a total of NOK 175 per week per child. If you provide for a child, you are entitled to child supplement even if the child does not live with you.

The child must live in Norway or another EEA country. If the child, over a period of 12 months, spends more than 90 days outside of Norway or another EEA country, you will no longer receive child supplement.

^ Were you recently discharged from the military?

If you were recently discharged from the Norwegian military, we will calculate your unemployment benefit based on an income of NOK 355 860 (3 G). If your income for the last 12 months was higher than this, you may be entitled to a higher unemployment benefit. NAV will calculate your unemployment benefit based on the income that will benefit you the most.

^ Are you receiving other financial support?

If you are you receiving other financial support, it may affect the amount of your unemployment benefit. You specify in the application the type of financial support you are receiving, and NAV will calculate how much your unemployment benefit will be reduced.

Remember to update your tax card

You must pay tax on the unemployment benefit you receive from NAV. You should [update your tax card](https://www.skatteetaten.no/en/person/taxes/tax-deduction-card-and-advance-tax/order-a-tax-deduction-card/) (<https://www.skatteetaten.no/en/person/taxes/tax-deduction-card-and-advance-tax/order-a-tax-deduction-card/>) when your monthly payments are reduced. Read more about [tax deduction](https://www.nav.no/skattetrekk) (<https://www.nav.no/skattetrekk>) on payments from NAV.

#when

When are payments made?

Kopier lenke: <https://www.nav.no/dagpenger/en#when>

Oppdatert 06/07/2023, 12:50

First payment

You will receive your first payment of unemployment benefit when your application is granted. [The processing time for unemployment benefit](https://www.nav.no/saksbehandlingstider/en#unemployment-benefits) (<https://www.nav.no/saksbehandlingstider/en#unemployment-benefits>) is currently **5 weeks**.

You will receive **back payment** from the day you were entitled to unemployment benefit.

You will not receive payment for the first 3 days of your unemployment benefit period. This is your deductible. NAV will deduct 3 days from your first unemployment benefit payment.

^ How is the deductible subtracted?

NAV cannot subtract the 3-day deductible if you are working, sick or on holiday. We must be able to subtract your deductible within the first 3 weeks of your unemployment benefit period. If we cannot make the subtraction, you will not receive a payment, and your unemployment benefit is stopped. If this happens, you have to submit a new application for unemployment benefit.

Regular payments

Unemployment benefit is paid every 14 days. You will receive the money 1–3 business days after submitting your employment status form (meldekort).

#how-long

How long can you receive unemployment benefit?

Kopier lenke: <https://www.nav.no/dagpenger/en#how-long>

Oppdatert 06/07/2023, 12:38

How long your unemployment benefit period is, is decided based on your income from the last 12 months, or your average income for the last 36 months. We will apply the alternative that benefits you the most.

- If you had an income of **NOK 237 240 (2 G) or more** in the last 12 months, or on average for the last 36 months, you may get unemployment benefit for a period of up to 104 weeks.
- If you had an income of **less than NOK 237 240 (2 G)** in the last 12 months, or on average for the last 36 months, you may get unemployment benefit for a period of up to 52 weeks.
- If you were recently discharged from the Norwegian military, you may get unemployment benefit for a period of up to 26 weeks.

^ What income determines how long your unemployment benefit period will be?

We use the following types of income to calculate how long your unemployment benefit period will be:

- Salary
- Parental benefit
- Pregnancy benefit
- Pregnancy-related sickness benefit

Self-employment income does not count as salary.

^ Have you received unemployment benefit for the last 52 weeks?

If you have received unemployment benefit for the last 52 weeks, you continue on the period you were granted the last time you received unemployment benefit. For example, if you were granted an unemployment benefit period of 52 weeks, and you were unemployed or temporarily laid off for 22 weeks, you still have 30 weeks left of your unemployment benefit period.

The notice you received when your application was granted, specifies how long your unemployment benefit period is.

If you have worked 12 weeks or more since you last received unemployment benefit, you can request a new calculation of your unemployment benefit amount. You request a new calculation in your application for unemployment benefit. We will apply the alternative that benefits you the most.

Additional rules apply if you have been temporarily laid off

In any 18-month period, your employer may only temporarily lay you off for a maximum of 26 weeks. During the first 15 days of your temporary lay-off period, your employer must pay you. These weeks will be in addition to the 26 weeks you can be temporarily laid off.

If you become unemployed after having been temporarily laid off, you can submit a new application for unemployment benefit. You will then continue your unemployment benefit period. For example, if you were granted an unemployment benefit period of 104 weeks, you now have 78 weeks left of your period.

^ Have you been temporarily laid off in the last 18 months?

If you are temporarily laid off again by the same employer within 18 months, you will continue your original 26-week temporary lay-off period. For example, if you were temporarily laid off for 20 weeks last time, you can now be temporarily laid off for 6 weeks.

If it is more than 18 months since the last time you were temporarily laid off from the same employer, your temporary lay-off period may last up to 26 weeks.

If you are temporarily laid off by another employer, you can be temporarily laid off from that job for 26 weeks, regardless of whether you have been laid-off before or not.

#apply.#apply

How to apply

Kopier lenke: <https://www.nav.no/dagpenger/en#apply>

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You should apply one week before the last day you are entitled to salary from your employer. To avoid losing days with unemployment benefit, you must apply, at the latest, on the day you no longer are entitled to salary.

Apply (<https://www.nav.no/start/soknad-dagpenger>)

When you apply digitally, it will take about 20–30 minutes. When you apply, you must also register as a job seeker. The application is in Norwegian.

What documents should you include in your application?

In your application, please upload documentation for the information you give NAV. If we have all the information we need when we start processing your application, you will receive an answer to your application sooner. Based on the information you provide in the application, you will be told what documents we need from you. There are some documents that most applicants must include.

Check to see what the following documents must include:

^ Employment contract

We need your employment contract to confirm information about your employment.

The employment contract must include

- what date you started your job
- your employment percentage or your agreed working hours
- agreed notice period for termination/resignation
- what date the employment ends, if you have a temporary employment contract

If you do not have an employment contract, or if your employment contract does not include all the necessary information, your employer can fill out the form [“Confirmation of reason for termination/reduced hours \(excl. lay-offs\)”](https://www.nav.no/fyllut/nav040803?sub=paper&lang=en) (<https://www.nav.no/fyllut/nav040803?sub=paper&lang=en>) (NAV 04-08.03).

^ Resignation/termination

If you have resigned from your job or if you have been terminated, we need to know why. That is why we need the notice of resignation you have handed in to your employer, or the notice of termination your employer have given you.

Have you resigned from you job?

In that case, your notice of resignation must include

- what date you gave your employer your notice of resignation
- the reason why you resigned

If you did not hand in a written reason for your resignation to your employer, you can include the reason why you resigned in your application to NAV.

Have you been terminated from your job?

In that case, your notice of termination must include

- what date you received the notice
- the reason for your termination

If you did not receive a notice of termination, or if your notice did not include all the necessary information, your employer can fill out the form [“Confirmation of reason for termination/reduced hours \(excl. lay-offs\)”](https://www.nav.no/fyllut/nav040803?sub=paper&lang=en) (<https://www.nav.no/fyllut/nav040803?sub=paper&lang=en>) (NAV 04-08.03).

Has your contract expired?

If your contract has expired, we do not need a notice of resignation/termination. Your employment contract will include information about the employment ending.

^ Notice of temporary lay-off

If you have been fully or partially temporarily laid off, we need to know why. That is why we need the notice of temporary lay-off you received from your employer.

The notice of temporary lay-off must include

- why you were temporarily laid off
- how many percent you have been temporarily laid off (degree of lay-off)
- start and potential end date for temporary lay-off period
- what date you received the notice
- whether the different parties in your workplace agree on the temporary lay-off (yes or no)

The notice must specify that the temporary lay-off concerns you.

How to upload paper documents

You can take photos of paper documents and upload these photos to your application. Make sure that the entire document is in the photo and that all text is readable. The file formats you can use are PDF, JPG or PNG. The file size must not be larger than 10 MB.

Do you not have all the documents right now?

Do you not have all the documents NAV needs right now? Submit what you have, then forward the rest of the documents later, **but within 14 days**. If you do not submit all documents in time, your application may be denied.

Forward documentation (<https://www.nav.no/start/ettersend-soknad-dagpenger>)

If you are unable to get all the documentation you need, [please contact NAV](https://www.nav.no/kontaktoss/en). (<https://www.nav.no/kontaktoss/en>)

When will you get an answer to your application?

When your application has been processed, you will receive a text message. You can find the answer to your application by logging in to nav.no.

[The processing time for unemployment benefit](https://www.nav.no/saksbehandlingstider/en#unemployment-benefits) (<https://www.nav.no/saksbehandlingstider/en#unemployment-benefits>) is currently 5 weeks. You will receive your first payment of unemployment benefit when your application is granted.

Submit your employment status form (meldekort) while you wait for an answer

When you have registered as a job seeker and you are waiting for your application to be processed, you must remember to submit your employment status form every 14 days. [Log in](https://nav.no/minside) (<https://nav.no/minside>) to see when your next form is due.

There are several things you must do after you apply. Check to see [what you must do while you wait for an answer #do.](#)

#do.#do

What must you do to get unemployment benefit?

Kopier lenke: <https://www.nav.no/dagpenger/en#do>

Oppdatert 06/07/2023, 12:54

After you have submitted your application for unemployment benefit and registered as a job seeker, there are some requirements of what you must do.

To qualify for unemployment benefit, you must

- submit employment status forms (meldekort)
- be a genuine job seeker
- be available to NAV
- notify NAV of changes

Have you not applied? This is [how you apply for unemployment benefit #apply.](#)

You must submit employment status forms

[The employment status form](https://www.nav.no/en/home/benefits-and-services/employment-status-form-how-do-you-use-it) (<https://www.nav.no/en/home/benefits-and-services/employment-status-form-how-do-you-use-it>) (meldekort) makes it possible for NAV to calculate how much unemployment benefit you are entitled to. You have to submit your employment status form every 14 days, throughout your entire unemployment benefit period.

Remember to submit employment status forms while you wait for an answer to your application. You can [log in](#) (<https://www.nav.no/minside/arbeidssoker?goTo=registrering>) to see when you need to send your first employment status form.

There are specific rules for how to fill out your employment status form. Read more about [how to fill out an employment status form](#) (<https://www.nav.no/en/home/benefits-and-services/employment-status-form-how-do-you-use-it/how-to-fill-out-the-employment-status-form-unemployment-and-employment-scheme-benefits>).

What happens if you do not submit your employment status form?

If you do not submit your employment status form in time, your payment will be reduced. If more than 20 days have passed since you last sent an employment status form, we will stop your unemployment benefit payment. In this case, you must reapply for unemployment benefit.

You must be a genuine job seeker

Being a genuine job seeker means that you must

- apply for jobs, go to interviews and keep your CV updated

- participate in [labour market schemes](https://www.nav.no/komme-i-jobb#stotte) (<https://www.nav.no/komme-i-jobb#stotte>), such as courses or training
- accept any kind of job, anywhere in Norway
- be able to start a new job on short notice
- be healthy enough to work at least a 50 percent job

^ What does it mean to accept any kind of job, anywhere in Norway?

If you are receiving unemployment benefit, you must be willing to accept any kind of job, anywhere in Norway. This means that you may have to accept a lower salary or a longer commute. You must be able to accept both full-time and part-time employment. The reason for this requirement is to increase your employment options.

You may get an exception from this requirement if

- you are over 60 years old
- you have health issues
- you are caring for a close family member
- you have a child under 1 year old in your care
- you are the sole carer for a child in primary school or younger
- you are the sole or joint carer for a child with special needs

There are other exceptions as well.

If you need an exception, include this in your application for unemployment benefit. You may be asked to provide documentation to confirm your situation.

^ What if you become too ill to work?

If you are more than 50 percent on sick leave, you will no longer be entitled to unemployment benefit, but you may be entitled to [sickness benefit](https://www.nav.no/sykmeldt-og-permittert) (<https://www.nav.no/sykmeldt-og-permittert>).

What happens if you are not a genuine job seeker?

Your unemployment benefit payments will be stopped

If you do not follow the requirements of your agreement with NAV to seek employment, we will stop your unemployment benefit payments.

Temporary stop of unemployment benefit payments

You will lose your unemployment benefit for 18 weeks if

- you turn down job offers
- you say no to participate in or withdraw from a [labour market scheme](https://www.nav.no/komme-i-jobb#stotte) (<https://www.nav.no/komme-i-jobb#stotte>).
- you resign from or otherwise quit your job
- you are dismissed or terminated due to circumstances for which you are to blame

If this happens more than once within 12 months, you may lose your unemployment benefit for 26 weeks.

You must continue to submit employment status forms, even if you do not receive unemployment benefit payments for a period. It is very important that you continue to submit your employment status forms on time, even in this period. If you fail to do so, your unemployment benefit case may be stopped and you will need to reapply.

You must be available to NAV

When you are receiving unemployment benefit, you must be available to NAV. Being available to NAV means you must respond to messages and other inquiries we send you.

What happens if you are not available to NAV?

NAV needs to be able to contact you to follow up on you as a job seeker. If we cannot reach you, we may stop your unemployment benefit payments.

You must notify NAV of changes

It is important that you notify NAV if your situation changes [#notify](#). This could include you getting more or less work, going on leave or being on sick leave.

#work

Work in combination with unemployment benefit

Kopier lenke: <https://www.nav.no/dagpenger/en#work>

Oppdatert 07/07/2023, 11:31

You may work while receiving unemployment benefit. How much you work will affect your payments.

If you work **within 50 percent of your regular working hours**, your unemployment benefit will be reduced for each hour you put on your employment status form (meldekort).

If you work **more than 50 percent of your regular working hours**, you will not receive any unemployment benefit.

Your regular working hours are specified in the letter you received when your application was granted.

^ How does NAV calculate your regular working hours?

When you receive unemployment benefit, NAV has calculated what we call “your regular working hours”.

This is calculated based on how much you worked before you became unemployed or were temporarily laid off.

If you worked **regular hours for at least 6 months** prior to becoming unemployed or being temporarily laid off, this will be your regular working hours. For example, if you regularly worked 37.5 hours per week, your regular working hours are 37.5 hours.

If you **did not work regular hours for at least 6 months** prior to becoming unemployed or being temporarily laid off, NAV will calculate your regular working hours. We add up all the hours you worked in the last 12 or 36 months, and calculate the average. In the application, select whether you prefer we calculate based on 12 or 36 months.

^ See example

If your regular working hours were 30 hours per week, your regular working hours for one employment status form period (2 weeks) will be 60 hours. You may then work up to 50 percent of 60 hours in one employment status form period and still receive a reduced unemployment benefit payment.

In this case, you could for example work

- 15 hours one week and 15 hours the other week, and you would still receive a reduced unemployment benefit payment.
- 25 hours one week and 5 hours the other week, and you would still receive a reduced unemployment benefit payment.
- 30 hours one week and 0 hours the other week, and you would still receive a reduced unemployment benefit payment.

If you work more than 50 percent of your regular working hours, within one employment status form period, you will not receive any unemployment benefit.

^ **Are you working more than 50 percent 6 weeks in a row?**

If you are working more than 50 percent of your regular working hours, 6 weeks in a row, we will stop your unemployment benefit payments. We do that because it looks like you are back to work and no longer need unemployment benefit. If you need unemployment benefit again, you must reapply.

^ **Are you working for the employer who temporarily laid you off?**

If you work for the employer who temporarily laid you off, in the same employment percentage as before, for more than 6 weeks in a row, the temporary lay-off is ended. If you get temporarily laid off again, you must receive a new notice of temporary lay-off and reapply for unemployment benefit.

Compensatory time off and free periods are not included in the calculation of these 6 weeks.

^ **Are you working in the fisheries industry?**

If you work for the employer who temporarily laid you off, in the same employment percentage as before, for more than 26 weeks in a row, the temporary lay-off is interrupted. If you get temporarily laid off again, you must receive a new notice of temporary lay-off and reapply for unemployment benefit.

You may work up to 60 percent of your regular working hours, and still receive a reduced unemployment benefit payment. If you work more than that, you will not receive any unemployment benefit for that employment status form period.

You must notify NAV if you get a job

If you get a job, you must [notify NAV](https://innboks.nav.no/s/skriv-til-oss?category=Arbeid) (https://innboks.nav.no/s/skriv-til-oss?category=Arbeid) as soon as you know when you will be starting your new job. That enables us to accurately calculate your unemployment benefit.

Remember to fill in all hours you work on your employment status form.

You should adjust your tax card

If you combine work with unemployment benefit, you should ask either your employer or NAV to use the percentage section of your tax card. We recommend doing this so you avoid paying too little in taxes.

Do you want to start your own business?

When you are receiving unemployment benefit, you may apply to keep your unemployment benefit for up to 12 months while starting your own business. This means you can work on your business without it affecting your unemployment benefit payments.

Apply for establishing (<https://www.nav.no/fyllut/nav040608?lang=en>)

If you do not have all the documents you need when submitting your application, you can forward the remaining ones as soon as possible.

Forward documentation (<https://www.nav.no/start/ettersendelse-soknad-dagpenger-virksomhet>)

^ Who qualifies for unemployment benefit while starting a business?

To qualify for unemployment benefit while starting a business, all of the following must apply to your situation:

- The business must be new.
- It must be possible for you to eventually earn a living through your business.
- You must own more than 50 percent of the business, either on your own or together with others who are also receiving unemployment benefit.
- If you lost your job in the last 6 months, your own actions cannot be the reason why you lost your job.

Are you unsure if this applies to you? Submit an application, and we will assess whether you are entitled to unemployment benefit while starting your own business.

^ How to apply

If you want to start your own business while receiving unemployment benefit, you should apply as soon as possible. This is because the starting of the business can only be approved from the day when the processing of your application is completed. If you work on your business before it has been approved, these work hours will lead to a reduction in your unemployment benefit payment.

To apply for unemployment benefit while starting your own business, you must:

- Submit a [business assessment](https://www.nav.no/fyllut/nav040610?lang=en) (<https://www.nav.no/fyllut/nav040610?lang=en>), with your application. You get this assessment by contacting the municipality in which you want to start your business.
- [Notify NAV](https://aktivitetsplan.nav.no/) (<https://aktivitetsplan.nav.no/>) of the fact that you want to start your own business while receiving unemployment benefit.
- Submit your [application for starting your own business](https://www.nav.no/fyllut/nav040608?lang=en) (<https://www.nav.no/fyllut/nav040608?lang=en>).

Are you not currently receiving unemployment benefit? Remember to also [apply for unemployment benefit](#) when you want to start your own business while receiving unemployment benefit.

^ Employment status forms while starting your own business

When you are starting a business while receiving unemployment benefit, there are special rules for filling out the employment status form. Read more about [the rules for filling out the employment status form](https://www.nav.no/en/home/benefits-and-services/employment-status-form-how-do-you-use-it/how-to-fill-out-the-employment-status-form-unemployment-and-employment-scheme-benefits).
(<https://www.nav.no/en/home/benefits-and-services/employment-status-form-how-do-you-use-it/how-to-fill-out-the-employment-status-form-unemployment-and-employment-scheme-benefits>)

^ Traveling abroad as part of starting your own business

Normally, you will not receive unemployment benefit during travels abroad. If you need to travel abroad as part of starting your business, you can apply to keep your unemployment benefit during your trip. Your application must be approved before you travel.

You apply by [writing to us](https://www.nav.no/skriv-til-oss/en) (<https://www.nav.no/skriv-til-oss/en>).

#complaint

How to make a complaint

Kopier lenke: <https://www.nav.no/dagpenger/en#complaint>

Oppdatert 05/07/2023, 13:23

Do you think we made the wrong decision regarding your case? If so, you can make a complaint to the NAV unit which made the decision. They will then reconsider your case. If they disagree with your complaint, they will pass it on to NAV Appeals.

Making a complaint about a decision

You can find information about how you can make a complaint, who to complain to and what the deadline is, in the letter you received regarding your case.

Send complaint (<https://klage.nav.no/en/klage/uinnlogget/DAGPENGEBEGRUNNELSE>)

Forward documentation (<https://klage.nav.no/en/ettersendelse/DAGPENGEBEGRUNNELSE>)

Making an appeal about a decision

If you believe the decision from NAV Appeals is incorrect, you may appeal the decision. There are some exceptions to this. You find the deadline to make an appeal in the letter you received.

Send appeal (<https://klage.nav.no/en/anke/uinnlogget/DAGPENGEBEGRUNNELSE>)

Forward documentation (<https://klage.nav.no/en/ettersendelse/DAGPENGGER>)

Making a complaint about repayment of advance payment of unemployment benefits

You can find information about how you can make a complaint, who to complain to and what the deadline is, in the letter you received regarding your case.

Send complaint (https://klage.nav.no/en/klage/uinnlogget/DAGPENGGER_TILBAKEBETALING_FORSKUDD/begrunnelse)

Forward documentation (https://klage.nav.no/en/ettersendelse/DAGPENGGER_TILBAKEBETALING_FORSKUDD)

Read more about your [right to appeal](https://www.nav.no/klagerettigheter/en) (<https://www.nav.no/klagerettigheter/en>).